Worse Than the Horde

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Angst with a Happy Ending, Wrongful Imprisonment, Evil Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Catra Is Sent to Beast Island (She-Ra), Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Redemption, Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Poor Catra (She-Ra), Protective Adora (She-Ra), Dark Glimmer (She-Ra), Queen Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Catra just wanted to find help. She wanted to be better, but when spotted by the Rebellion... Let's just say she isn't greeted with hugs and kind words.

Adora finds out four days later.

OR

Glimmer is in her 'dark queen' era and Adora is having absolutely none of it.

Notes

You will probably be very angry with Glimmer after reading this. I love Glimmer, but season four was definitely not her at her best. I basically just... Amplified it? I intended to release some kind of GlimBow fic or Adora/Glimmer sister fic soon to show her love 😭

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra gasped for breath as she hopped over a log and kept racing through the Whispering Woods. Tears pricked the corners of her eyes as she ran, praying the Rebellion wouldn't capture her. Ever since the portal, she'd had a wanted poster out for her, promising a substantial reward for turning her in.

She'd made the mistake of using the woods to try and spy on a Rebellion camp, and was now being chased by the princesses after the ice brat saw her. She'd be lying if she said she wasn't absolutely terrified. The last time she saw Adora, she'd glared at her with clear anger, hurt, and- worst of all, hate. She wasn't ready to face her again, to see that same look aimed at her from the girl she still secretly loved so much.

Catra shrieked when sharp pellets of ice raced past her, a couple managing to scrape her cheek and draw blood. She could feel the heavy breaths bubbling up in her chest.

Her fears skyrocketed when she dared a glance behind her and almost immediately tripped over a root, crying out as it twisted her ankle and sent her to the ground. She looked up just as the princesses surround her. Sparkles, Flowers, Fish Face, and the Ice Brat, glaring down at her as they surrounded her.

"Looks like you're coming to Brightmoon, Horde Scum," Glimmer smirked, nodding to Perfuma, who began to send vines wrapping around the brunette's legs.

"W-Wait! No, please-" Catra stammered out, the claustrophobic feeling coming to the surface of her mind and body. She screamed again as more vines grabbed her wrists and pinned them behind her, keeping her from using her hands, "P-please stop-!" She cried, unable to stop the tears from running down her face.

"Shut it, Scum before I make you." Glimmer snapped, "I'm not dealing with your snarky attitude the whole way back!"

"Glimmer I think she might be-"

"Perfuma please, do not start with your weird hippie shit." Mermista groaned.

Desperate, and on the verge of a panic attack, she had to try again, "G-Glimmer p-please I can't breathe I- I need-"

"I said shut up!" The queen glared, grabbing her by her scruff and forcing her to her feet, "You are a prisoner to the Rebellion now, and now that I'm queen, I've had a *real* prison built, and there's a cell with your name on it." She seethed. Catra wasn't sure if she was being fueled by rage at her or something else entirely. All she did know was that her ankle now stung and she was seriously struggling to catch a steady breath, "Now you are going to walk back to the castle, and if you so much as even try to escape, I will make sure you can't walk. Got it?"

"B-but you tied my a-ankles-"

"I know. We'll free them, but I have another way to make sure you can't run first."

Catra wasn't sure if it was the smile on the queen's face, or the tone she was using (maybe both), but she was absolutely terrified at anything her captor had in mind.

⚔

They were just over halfway to Brightmoon, and Catra was having a full on panic attack. Glimmer had attached a collar to her neck and was using a vine from Perfuma as the leash, despite the flower princesses' objection.

Catra had only ever revealed how sensitive she was to collars to one person, and she knew Adora would never talk about it with anyone. Sure, they were fighting against each other in war, but Adora was good at keeping things that personal to herself.

She never knew much about her heritage or species in general. When they were cadets in the Horde, she and Adora once got into some files that had been thrown out, and discovered a few things noted about her kind. One of which was about collars and how they were special. They were only meant to be put on her or given to her by her mate. Any situation otherwise, ie her current one, was a sign of heavy disrespect and objectification.

This wasn't the first time she'd been in a similar situation, with Shadow Weaver, and that was before finding the papers.

She gasped when the leash suddenly yanked, briefly choking her as she was forced along, "Hurry up, Horde Scum!"

"I twisted my ankle, I'm sorry-"

"Does it *look* like I care?!"

"Glimmer, maybe you should let her take her time. She's going through a lot-"

"I don't care, Perfuma!" Glimmer snapped, causing Perfuma to flinch, "I've had a bad day and I'm ready to imprison the bastard causing me the most trouble! Now get moving!"

Catra cried out as her ankle was roughly forced over a rock, tripping her. She whimpered, biting down her pain as she struggled to remain on her feet.

"Well, we should at least ask Adora to he-"

"Adora isn't going to be seeing her. She has more important things to do."

Anger coursed through the magicat, she knew about Adora being used and she couldn't stay quiet, "You mean by being your distraction?" She sneered, raising an eyebrow.

"Excuse me?!" Glimmer stopped in her tracks and turned to face her captive, "She is NOT-"

"-I'm not fucking stupid, it's obvious you have been. What a good friend." She rolled her eyes, sarcasm dripping from her tone.

"She's fighting for the Rebellion, and doing what she can. How dare you suggest I'm being a bad friend! Look at how you treat your own friendships before coming at me!"

Tears rolled down Catra's face, her body trembling slightly.

Glimmer smirked, "That's what I thought."

Though terrified, she was also angry, and didn't want Glimmer to have the satisfaction of winning the argument, "*Fuck you*!" She snapped, before spitting in the queen's face.

Glimmer took a moment to process what happened, before grabbing the collar and yanking Catra close to her, "You will regret that, Horde Scum!"

"Mm- yeah? How? Gonna sparkle at me?"

"Nope. I had a feeling I'd need to shut you up, so I came prepared." She explained, before pulling a black cloth out of her pocket and gagging Catra with it, tying it around her head.

"Mph! Mm-" Catra's eyes widened, her pupils mere slits as she realized just how truly vulnerable and helpless she was.

⚔

It took another hour before they finally arrived at Brightmoon. "Where's Adora?" She asked the nearest guard.

"In the war room with the others, Your Majesty."

"Good, she's busy then. Take this Scum to the prison and make sure she's secure." She said, thrusting the leash to one of the guards, "And don't let Adora see her. Understand?"

"Yes, Your Majesty."

Catra cried out into her gag as she was forced forward into the arms of men she didn't know intent on locking her away.

"Glimmer, what about her leg?" Perfuma asked, raising an eyebrow.

"Ugh, right. Just bandage it or something." Glimmer rolled her eyes, "Now come on." She placed her hands on her friends' shoulders and teleported.

"Move along, prisoner." One commanded, both grabbing her arms and forcing her forward.

It only took a few minutes walk and a single spiral staircase down to get her to the prison, where she was uncaringly pushed to the floor, drawing a muffled shriek out of her. She was barely a breath away from hyperventilating when two guards towered over her, cutting away the vines, only to grab chains attached to the wall and forcing her arms up before cuffing them. She screamed in pure fear when her ankles were grabbed next, cuffs attached to the floor clipping around them. Essentially, she was now mute and forced to be still, "Be a good kitty and maybe we'll remove the gag.. eventually." One guard said, both chuckling as they stepped out of the cell and locked her inside.

The final straw was the collar they'd left attached to her, the vine leash laying limply in front of her and the last sentence said to her.

Gasping for breath barely available due to her gag, Catra could only sob and fruitlessly struggle until she passed out from pain and exhaustion.

⚔

Adora was mad. No, she was *livid*. Catra had been being held prisoner for the past four days and she only just found out, thanks to a very distressed and concerned Perfuma. Stars bless that princess. She and Bow were about the only two she trusted right now.

Now she was storming down to the prison, sword drawn, a death glare fixed on her face. She reached the door, and descended the stairs, only to be stopped at the entry by guards.

"Sorry, princess, the queen requested you not to be permitted in here."

"Yeah, the queen can go fuck herself. Let me through, NOW, before my sword finds its way down your *throat*."

Gulping, and not wanting to deal with the fury of She-Ra, they timidly stepped aside, and allowed her to pass.

"Good decision." She stated simply, before walking in and looking for an occupied cell. As she expected, Catra was in the one furthest back, but what she saw fueled her rage even more than she thought possible, her cheeks turning red as she fought not to implode.

Catra was lying on her side, eyes closed, her arms hanging above her by chains, and her legs chained down as well. She looked exhausted, and clearly wasn't being fed properly. She could swear she was even covered in bruises. Had those guards laid a hand on her?!!

But that wasn't what angered the blonde the most (although make no mistake, it made her FURIOUS). No, what really pissed her off was the collar tightly clipped around her neck, and the vine leash attached. She had a pretty good idea of who put it there, and she was going to *pay*.

"Catra..?" She whispered, love and care automatically filling her tone.

Flinching, the magicat shakily looked up, eyes widening when she saw who was visiting her. Unfortunately the sword didn't give her the brightest idea of why she was there, "P-Please Adora… please… please don't hurt me… I… I'm so sorry.. I.. I didn't…" was all she could get out before she broke down, crying softly.

"Why would you- oh! Right, I'm sorry! No, I'm not here for that." She quickly transformed her sword to a key and unlocked the cell door, stepped inside, and crouched next to her old friend, "In fact,

I should be apologizing. I wish I knew you were here sooner, I would have come here immediately. Perfuma told me a few minutes ago. She told me briefly what happened, but… I wanted- no I needed to hear it from you. Do you think you could tell me? Especially about the…collar."

Whimpering, Catra slowly tried to sit up, before hissing in pain and falling back over.

"Oh my-" Adora's eyes widened, "You're hurt. Okay, you know what, we'll talk in a moment, but would it be alright if I healed you first?"

Her fur stood up at the thought of more magic being used on her, but being alone and finally with a friendly face she needed, she wasn't going to complain, "That's okay… but Adora… could you take off the arm chains and collar? I- I understand if you need to leave the ankle ones."

This wasn't the Catra Adora had been fighting for almost three years now, this was her Catra. Smiling softly, she nodded, before undoing all of her restraints and the collar, which she chucked out of the cell to be as far from them as possible, "There, is that better..?"

Catra would be lying if she said she wasn't surprised at being completely freed and granted movement. Ears pinned, she nodded gently.

"Good, now tell me where it hurts?"

"Fuck.. Everywhere. But my ankle is- well it was sprained but I think it's broken now."

"Alright, close your eyes, I need to transform."

Closing her eyes, Catra listened as the signature phrase she hated was spoken, and a bright light engulfed the room, before leaving She-Ra in its place. She opened her eyes when she heard the warrior shuffle closer, "Can I hold you?"

Her heart fluttered, and she could only manage a silent nod before she was so carefully lifted into She-Ra's arms, cradled close, their foreheads touching as the healing glow began to surround and flow through her. She sighed, smiling as she relaxed, all feelings of pain spreading throughout her body.

By the time she was healed, Adora had detransformed and a purr had begun emitting quietly from the brunette, "Feel better?"

"Mhm.. My ankle has a little pain, but so much better than before. Th.. thank you, Adora."

"I'm glad to help. Now… How did all this happen? And please be completely honest with me."

Though she tensed, her body relaxed moments later when Adora gave her a comforting squeeze, "Okay… so, I left the Frightzone for starters. I.. couldn't handle it there anymore, and I was- spying on a Rebellion camp because I was hoping to find some help in recruiting Scorpia and saving Entrapta…"

"From what?"

"Well…" her ears pinned back again, "I sent her to Beast Island because she refused to open the portal. But I know she's smart and strong so I'm desperately hoping she's okay."

"That's sweet, thank you for telling me. We'll get a rescue mission set up, but what happened when you were spotted at the camp?"

Taking a shaky breath, Catra closed her eyes, "The ice princess saw me and- and they all started chasing me even after I tried to call truce. T-they chased me for almost twenty minutes before I tripped on a tree root and twisted my ankle… Perfuma used her vines to restrain me, but was trying to point out my ankle was hurt but.. but Glimmer…"

"Glimmer what, Catra?"

"....she ignored her. Mermista told her to 'shut up with her hippie shit'. I was having a panic attack and trying to say I couldn't

breathe, and Perfuma once again tried to say something, but Glimmer just gr-grabbed my scruff and forced me to walk… and because of the vines around my ankles, they had to cut them for me to walk and… and Glimmer said she had a way to k-keep me from running…" tears began rolling down her face, her voice shaky and timid, more than Adora had ever seen heard they were little, "SS-Sh-She put the collar on me and used the vines she cut off as a leash! She yanked it and choked me if I was too slow the entire way back… then you were mentioned, said you were busy. I got mad and said 'as your distraction?', which really made her mad. She told me to check my own friendships before commenting on hers, and that set me off so I- I spit in her face, and then she- she gagged me with a cloth… a cloth that didn't get removed until y-yesterday…!"

Finally, she just broke down and cried. Burying her face in Adora's chest and crying, her body trembling. The latter frowned, sliding off her jacket and draping it over Catra's shoulders, "Shhh, just let it out, tell me at your pace okay..?"

Only managing a small mewl as a response, Catra clung to Adora, crying for nearly ten minutes and letting it all out of her system.

"Better..?" Adora whispered, running her fingers through her mane.

"M-mhm…" Catra sniffled, curling up more in her lap to get comfortable.

"Okay, what happened after you got here?"

Taking another deep breath, she slowly exhaled before continuing, "...Glimmer told the guards to secure me and- to make sure you didn't find out I was here. Perfuma, again, asked about my ankle, Glimmer rolled her eyes and said to 'bandage it or something,' which they didn't do, before teleporting with the princesses. The guards dragged me down here and chained me down and o-one of them said that if I 'was a good kitty' they may eventually ungag me…" she shivered at the memory while Adora tightened her protective grip on Catra, her eyebrows furrowing, "Then I spent the rest of that day and the next being taunted, beaten, and threatened. The third day they finally fed me, and subsequently took the gag out, and today, well…"

"Fuck, Catra…" Adora managed, "I am so sorry you didn't deserve any of that."

"I probably did after all I've-"

"No, fuck that! I don't care what you've done, you don't deserve to be treated like an animal!"

Sniffling, Catra started purring again, clinging to Adora in a hug, "I'm so sorry for everything, Adora… I promise to find a way to make it up to you. Please… can you let me stay with you..?"

"Of course, Catra. I'm going to make sure justice is served for the crimes committed against you. Starting with Glimmer. Think you can walk?"

"Yeah, just- stay close?"

Nodding, Adora carefully helped Catra put on her jacket before helping her stand, her arm wrapping around her waist as they left the prison behind.

⚔

Glimmer groaned as she flopped back into her chair, "Where is Adora? We need to get this meeting over with so we can actually start our missions!"

"I'm right here, Glimmer." Adora seethed, pushing open the door, revealing a timid Catra gripping onto her arm next to her.

"What is *she* doing here?!" Glimmer snapped, standing up, "I didn't sign a release form for her!"

"Yeah well, I don't really care. She told me everything that happened in the past few days. I think that's going to be the topic of the meeting. You know, for those who haven't heard."

Spinnerella, Netossa, and Bow shared concerned looks. Adora had never been this angry before. The others in the room excluding Perfuma all now looked nervous or guilty.

Perfuma got to her feet and approached the two, "Would you like me to watch Catra for you? I know this is about to be..confrontational."

"That would be great, thank you Perfuma."

Smiling and nodding, she watched Adora approach the table before turning to Catra, "May I..?"

Nodding, Catra relaxed into Perfuma's arms when she was gently pulled into her arms, "Thank you..for everything." The brunette whispered.

"Of course." The princess smiled, guiding her over to a couch so they could sit down.

Once she was sure Catra was comfortable and safe, Adora turned her attention to the table, "Now, Glimmer, would you be ever so kind as to tell me why you felt the need to *blatantly ignore* Catra twisting her ankle, her VERY clear panic attack, and gagging her during said panic attack just because you wanted to?!"

"I'm sorry- *wHat*?" Bow exclaimed, not sure if he was more concerned or angry.

"Oh! On top of that, you allowed guards to literally beat and taunt her, and not feed her for two days just to leave the gag in so she couldn't scream!"

"I- I did what I needed to to make sure she didn't escape! She's a high ranking war criminal, Adora!"

"Oh for fuck's sake Glimmer she was TERRIFIED. To make things worse you did all this knowing she was trying to call a truce. She was coming to you for help in joining the Rebellion, recruiting Scorpia, and SAVING Entrapta, who, by the way, is trapped on Beast Island!"

"Probably because of HER!"

"SHE'S TRYING TO SAVE HER! At that point how she got there is fucking irrelevant! You're just pulling shit excuses out of your ass because you don't want to face the fact you were using methods much too aggressive and outright abusive to someone who *clearly* wasn't a threat! What kind of a message does that send out when someone looking to help us was beaten and abused by the queen? Not a very good one!"

"Okay wait a minute!" Bow held up his hands, "So, Catra was trying to come for help, called a truce, and Glimmer responded like that?"

"Ha! That wasn't even the worst thing she did! She used a collar and leash to restrain her perimeter! Not that you would know, but collars are a *very* sacred thing to magicats. They are ONLY to be given or used on her by her mate, anything else is a sign of deep disrespect and objectification!"

Glimmer's eyes widened as the realization slowly set in.

"Glimmer, this is getting out of control. Ever since you started taking magic lessons from Shadow Weaver-" Netossa was cut off by the magicat.

"WHAT?!" Catra shot up, looking at the queen, "Are you fucking stupid?! All she's gonna do is use you to gain power in the say so of what happens to Brightmoon!"

"Thank you!!" Bow and Adora exclaimed together at the same time.

Glimmer remained silent for a moment before, unsurprisingly, attempting to completely change the conversation, "I will not have a war criminal in my castle."

"She says as all of us have committed some kind of war crime." Netossa said, rolling her eyes.

"If Catra doesn't stay here, then *I* am not staying here!" Adora declared, furrowing her eyebrows.

"And where would you go?" Glimmer crossed her arms, her tone smug like she knew she couldn't leave.

"Plumeria." Perfuma spoke up immediately, "They're both welcome in my kingdom if Brightmoon is to be so exclusionary."

"Wha- no! Adora is not leaving! Not when she's such a high ranked soldier to the war. As queen I will not allow her to-"

"I don't know where the Glimmer I met years ago went, but you are NOT her." Adora said, solemnly, "The Glimmer I know was kind and caring, not- not Shadow Weaver 2.0. And while I will always fight for Etheria, I am *done* fighting for you."

With that, Adora turned on her heel and returned to Catra, who happily allowed her to lift her into her arms, a purr starting to rumble from her chest.

"I think we'll be following you, Perfuma. At least for now."

"Absolutely, come on, maybe Swift Wind will give us a ride."

"I'm sure he will." Adora smiled, ignoring the queen's calls as the three departed from Brightmoon.

Glimmer immediately looked to Bow for help, but the archer only shook his head, "I think you have a lot to think about." Was all he said before he too left the room.

⚔

Adora took a deep breath, slowly exhaling before opening her eyes.

"Feel better?"

"Yeah.. Much, thanks." Adora smiled at Perfuma, before turning to Catra, who was lying under The Heart-Blossom, on her back, smiling as she sunbathed. Adora wasn't sure she'd ever seen her so relaxed.

"You should talk to her…" Perfuma hummed, smiling knowingly.

"What?" The blonde turned to her, before her eyes widened, "Oh! I.. Are you sure? Is this the right time to-"

"-Adora." She placed a calming hand on her shoulder, "This is as good a time as any. Just- take it slow."

"Okay…" taking another deep breath, Adora made her way over and took a seat next to Catra, whose eyes slowly cracked open to look at her.

"Hey, Adora…"

"Hey, Catra… how are you doing?"

"Better… this place is really peaceful…"

"That's good. I was thinking we could.. maybe build a cabin here or in the Whispering Woods. Just for us..?"

Ears perking up, Catra sat up and looked at Adora, eyes wide and dilated, "You.. mean it?"

"I do. Look, Catra I… I love you. So much, and I… I never thought I would see you again, not like this…"

Tears welled up in Catra's eyes. She scooted closer and looped her arms over the blonde's shoulders, "I… I love you too!"

Smiling like a dork, Adora couldn't hold back, and leaned in, crashing her lips against Catra's. The two clung to each other, pouring their love into the embrace, tears running down both of their faces.

When they pulled apart, Catra settled herself into Adora's lap, "What about Glimmer..?"

"I'll deal with her eventually. She needs time to think and realize what she's done. Hordak?"

"Another day." The magicat blushed, smiling.

"Agreed. Let's take today to just be together, and tomorrow we'll go save Entrapta."

"Sounds perfect."

The new couple curled up, cuddling up together under the tree, just holding each other and enjoying the setting of the day moon, and taking this moment to just be happy.

End Notes

Yes I pulled some Magicat lore out of my ass for this, but it kinda makes sense to me and I might use it again in the future.

I was inspired very loosely by a movie I watched last night with the family. I am pretty satisfied with how it turned out though!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!